

DEPARTMENT OF COMPUTER SCIENCE & ENGINEERING

AWS STUDENT BUILDER GROUP

Breaking Bug: The Amazon Q Debugging Contest

100 PARTICIPANTS · TEAMS OF 2-3 · 8TH OCTOBER 2026

Welcome to Breaking Bug



PHASE 1

The Hacker's Challenge

STORY-DRIVEN DEBUGGING // HACKER CONTROL METER

- Debug through code snippets, bug identification & stack traces
- Analyze error logs, API debugging & output prediction
- Spot bad code and choose the correct response
- Respond live to the hacker's direct messages

Every correct answer: +15% Recovery. Every wrong answer: +25% Corruption — the meter reacts instantly, so accuracy matters more than guessing. Top-performing teams qualify for Phase 2.

50 TEAMS ADVANCE → PHASE 2

PHASE 2

Mission Control

AMAZON Q DEVELOPER // LIVE LEADERBOARD // SYSTEM INTEGRITY METER

- One code snippet, one bug, one objective per mission
- Explain, debug & refactor code using Amazon Q Developer
- Optimize solutions and generate tests for each mission
- Live leaderboard, countdown & random hacker attack events

+20% System Integrity per completed mission, -20% Integrity / +20% Corruption per wrong solution — both accuracy and speed count. Top-performing teams qualify for the final phase.

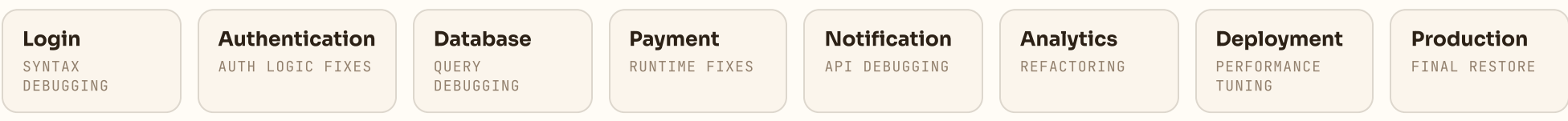
25 TEAMS ADVANCE → FINAL PHASE

FINAL PHASE

Core Recovery

AUTO-VALIDATED CHAMBERS // NO MANUAL JUDGING // FIRST TO PRODUCTION WINS

- Only the first chamber is unlocked at the start — every solved chamber unlocks the next
- Teams progress through eight interconnected system chambers in sequence



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ONE WINNING TEAM + ONE RUNNER-UP CROWNED

EVENT GUIDE

BREAKING BUG // COMPUTER SCIENCE & ENGINEERING // 8TH OCTOBER 2026

PHASE	TITLE	FORMAT & MECHANICS	OUTCOME
Phase 1	The Hacker's Challenge	Story-driven debugging quiz; Hacker Control meter reacts live to answers	50 teams advance
Phase 2	Mission Control	Independent debugging missions using Amazon Q Developer; live leaderboard	25 teams advance
Final Phase	Core Recovery	8 sequential, auto-validated debugging chambers from Login to Production	Winner + Runner-Up crowned

Breaking Bug

Breaking Bug is a story-driven debugging mission where participant teams play the engineers racing to stop a hacker from taking down their company's systems. Across three phases, teams face code-snippet puzzles, live debugging missions powered by Amazon Q Developer, and a sequence of auto-validated recovery chambers. The first team to fully restore the Production chamber is crowned the winner, with the closest team behind them named runner-up.

QUICK OVERVIEW — THE FLOW

100 Participants
Teams of 2-3

3 Phases
Elimination-based

Winner + Runner-Up
Final outcome

EVENT ROUNDS

Phase 1 — The Hacker's Challenge

- Code snippets, bug identification, stack traces & error logs
- API debugging, output prediction & spotting bad code
- Live responses to the hacker's direct messages

50 TEAMS ADVANCE

Phase 2 — Mission Control

- Independent missions: one snippet, one bug, one objective
- Explain, debug, refactor, optimize & test with Amazon Q Developer
- Live leaderboard, countdown & random hacker attack events

25 TEAMS ADVANCE

Final Phase — Core Recovery

- 8 auto-validated chambers: Login → Authentication → Database → Payment → Notification → Analytics → Deployment → Production
- Each chamber unlocks the next only once solved — no manual judging

WINNER + RUNNER-UP CROWNED

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